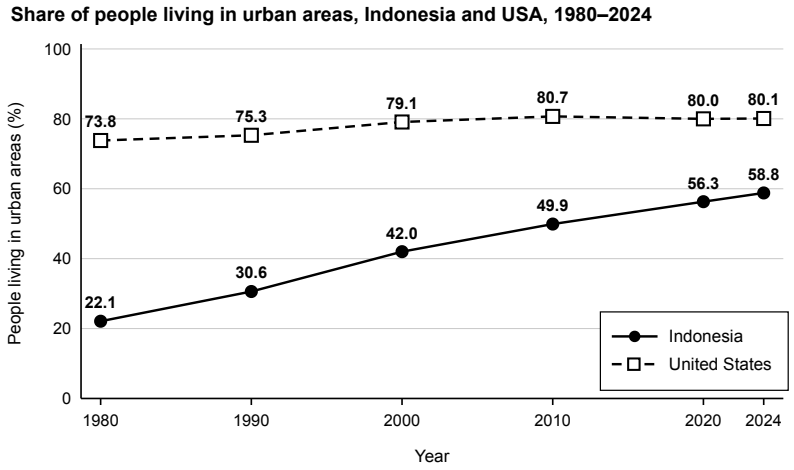
Lesson 1 · Reading line graphs and describing trends

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention: We are learning to read line graphs accurately and to describe trends in urbanisation using data.
Success criteria: □ I can name the title, axes, units and key of a line graph. □ I can identify a value and write it with its unit. □ I can describe a trend (direction, data with years and units, any anomaly). □ I can explain one consequence of rapid urbanisation (cause → effect).

We do: the United States and Indonesia



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators: Urban population (% of total population), based on United Nations World Urbanization Prospects. Accessed 20 October 2026.

(a) **Identify** the percentage of the United States' population living in urban areas in 2020. *(1 mark)*

_____

_____

(b) **Describe** the trend in urbanisation in the United States between 1980 and 2024. *(2 marks)*

Urbanisation in the United States _____ between 1980 and 2024. The share of people living in urban areas rose from _____ in 1980 to _____ in 2024. However, it _____ between _____ and _____, from _____ to _____.

increased rapidly | increased gradually | remained stable | fell slightly | levelled off | per cent (%)

(c) **Explain** one consequence of rapid urbanisation for the people or the environment of Indonesia's cities. *(2 marks)*
Cause → Effect → Impact. Use: so · because · as a result · which means that

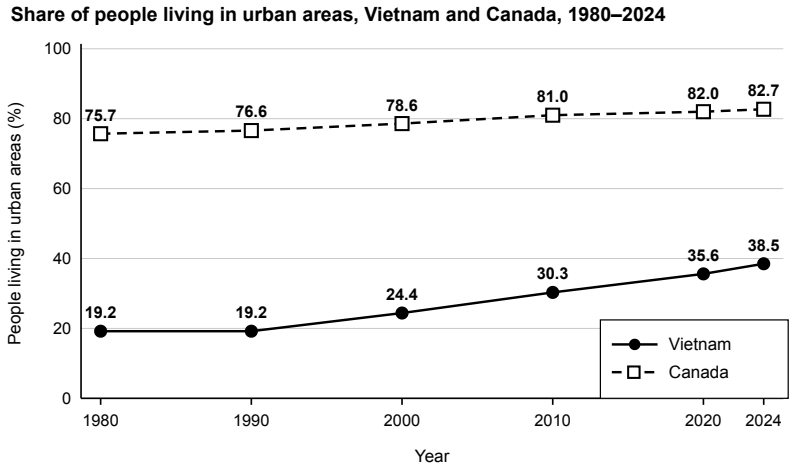
_____

_____

_____

_____

You do: Vietnam and Canada



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators: Urban population (% of total population), based on United Nations World Urbanization Prospects. Accessed 20 October 2026.

(a) **Identify** the percentage of Vietnam's population living in urban areas in 2010. *(1 mark)*

(b) **Describe** the trend in urbanisation in Vietnam between 1980 and 2024. Use data from the graph. *(2 marks)*

(c) **Explain** one consequence of rapid urbanisation for the people or the environment of Vietnam's cities. *(2 marks)*

Extension: Compare the trends in Vietnam and Canada, using data for both. Suggest one reason why urbanisation slows down once most people already live in cities.

You do: scaffolded version

(a) In 2010, _____ % of Vietnam's population lived in urban areas. *Remember the % sign.*

(b) Use T E A.

T + A: Between 1980 and 1990, urbanisation in Vietnam _____ at _____ %.

T: After 1990 it _____,

E: reaching _____ % in _____.

stayed the same | increased steadily | increased rapidly | fell | 19.2 | 38.5 | 2024

(c) Choose ONE idea, then complete the frame.

Idea bank: more cars and motorbikes → air pollution · not enough houses → crowded informal settlements · cities spread onto farmland and bushland → habitat lost

As more people move to cities such as Hanoi, _____

so _____.

As a result, _____.

Exit ticket (or use a sticky note): **Describe** the trend in urbanisation in Canada between 1980 and 2024 in one sentence. Use data for two years.

_____

_____